

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Rawia El Harram

Address: Flat 4 Kingswood Mansions 45 Worcester Road Sutton SM2 6PY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my strong support for Planning Application DM2025/01591.

I am a mother of four children - three boys and one girl - all of whom are now in secondary school. As a family, we have been attending BASMA events since my children were very young. Over the years, I have seen firsthand how important structured community activities are in shaping young people's confidence, character and sense of belonging.

Raising teenagers in today's world comes with many challenges. Having positive spaces where young people can gather, learn, and be guided by responsible adults makes a significant difference. The proposal to create a mixed-use Place of Worship (Class F1) and Community Hub (Class F2) would provide exactly that - a safe, organised and welcoming environment for young people during some of the most formative years of their lives.

For families like mine, a dedicated local hub would offer consistency and stability. Educational programmes, youth activities and wellbeing initiatives help keep children engaged in constructive ways, strengthen friendships and reinforce positive values. This kind of facility is not just beneficial for individual families, but for the wider community, as it encourages responsibility, respect and social cohesion.

As a mother, I also strongly value the inclusion of dedicated space and activities for women and girls. It is important that my daughter, as well as other young women in the area, has access to a safe and supportive environment where she can learn, grow and feel part of her local community.

In terms of the building itself, the proposed extensions appear modest and proportionate to the site. The development remains in keeping with the surrounding residential area. The provision of 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays, along with cycle storage, demonstrates careful planning around access and sustainability. The staggering of Friday prayer times to avoid school pick-up periods is also reassuring and reflects a responsible approach to managing activity levels.

Over the years, I have seen how much children benefit from a strong sense of community. This proposal represents an opportunity to provide a permanent and well-managed space that supports families, strengthens neighbourhood ties and positively shapes the next generation.

For these reasons, I respectfully ask the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591.